LIMBO

"Pilot Episode"

by

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OVER BLACK:

Heavy breathing.

CUT TO:

INT. LIMBO CABIN - NIGHT

A glitchy lamp serves as the only source of light in the sapless cement cabin.

SANDRA (35), a confident and natural leader, frantically stuffs a backpack with bananas and water bottles. She wears all black with a purple scarf around her neck.

DOLORES (80S), sits motionless in a wheelchair. She lays her eyes on Sandra, but her gaze seems distant.

Sandra zips the backpack and rushes to Dolores. She wraps the scarf around Dolores's neck and kisses her cheek.

SANDRA
Let's go, Mom.

EXT. LIMBO STREETS - NIGHT

Dolores hides in a dark corner of the deserted Limbo streets. She stares attentively at one of the few light posts. It glitches rhythmically.

FOOTSTEPS approach her, taking her out of her trance. It's Sandra.

SANDRA
It's clear. We should go now.

Dolores groans.

Sandra pushes her chair carefully but rapidly down the shadowy street.

The two arrive at a big fence that circles the perimeter. Underneath it, a hole creates a passage.

Sandra lifts Dolores out of the wheelchair. She groans again.

SANDRA (CONT'D)
We just need to get you to the other side. C'mon.

She gently pushes Dolores as she slides down the hole.

Sandra effortlessly crawls to the other side. She anxiously looks back before pulling Dolores out.

SANDRA (CONT'D)
I'll be right back.

She crawls back to the other side.

Dolores SHUTS her eyes. They uncontrollably move from one side to the other, until...

She OPENS them. They are pitch black. Lifeless.

On the other side, Sandra grabs the wheelchair and pushes it down the hole. Sandra ascends with it, but her proud look quickly turns to despair. Dolores is gone.

SANDRA (CONT'D)
Mom?

She looks around in anguish. Footprints. Her eyes follow the path made by them that leads to the woods. Sandra impulsively sprints into the darkness.

EXT. WOODS - CONTINUOUS

Sandra RUNS aimlessly with tears in her eyes, ignoring the leaves and thorns that scratch her face.

She slows down as the footsteps reach an end. Sandra slowly tilts her head up.

TWO RED SILHOUETTES stare at her in the distance. She FREEZES. Her hands tremble furiously.

A SHADOW approaches her from behind. It's Dolores. She carries a wood stick and has a dull look. Her eyes are pitch black.

CRACK!

Dolores steps on a branch. Sandra starts to turn, when...
HIT!

FADE OUT.

INT. MANU'S CAR - NIGHT

MANU (24), intelligent and unstable, drives along a parking lot. His swollen red eyes analyze the crowd.

RICARDO (28), mysterious but easygoing, rides shotgun. They both wear suits.

RICARDO
Manu? MANU, WATCH OUT!

Manu STEPS on the brake. The car abruptly STOPS. A few inches away, a KID looks at them startled. Manu turns off the car.

The kid flips his middle finger and walks away.

Ricardo and Manu catch their breath.

RICARDO (CONT'D)
Are you ok man?

MANU
This was a bad idea. I shouldn't have come.

RICARDO
Do you wanna go back?

Beat.

MANU
I can't. I didn't come for the funeral, this is the least I can do.

RICARDO
Then get it together.

MANU
You're right.

Manu takes a deep breath. Ricardo places his hand on his shoulder.

RICARDO
It'll be okay.

MANU
Thanks. It's hard to be sober in these moments.

RICARDO
Tell me about it.

Manu starts the car again.

INT. CHURCH - NIGHT

Manu and Ricardo step into the room. The crowd is dispersed in small groups.

RICARDO
The whole town, huh?

MANU
You're not helping.

The two make their way through the crowd. No one pays attention to them.

Manu's eyes lock on something that causes him to slow down. It's a big photograph of a young woman.

Piles of flowers gather around it. Attached to the frame, a sign reads: "EMA SÁ" (05/24/1985- 12/18/2009)".

Manu freezes. Ricardo observes him, a few feet away.

SARA (27), who is definitely not fun at parties, sees Manu from afar. Her eyes widen. She abandons the group she talks to and makes her way toward him.

Manu's gaze turns from the photograph to DONA SÁ (60). She looks out of a window, blue and alone.

SARA
What the hell Manu?

Sara catches him by surprise. He opens his mouth, but nothing comes out. Ricardo steps in.

RICARDO
Hey, there is no need for t--

MANU
Excuse me.

SARA
What--

Manu quickly walks past her. Ricardo and Sara frown. They follow Manu with their eyes.

Sara grows pale. His path leads to Dona Sá.

SARA (CONT'D)
Oh no.

Sara rushes towards them, but it's too late.

Dona Sá looks back. Her face shuts when she recognizes him.

MANU
Dona Sá--

DONA SÁ
What are you doing here?

MANU
I just wanted to give you my condolences. I wasn't here for--

DONA SÁ
Who invited you?

Sara finally gets there.

DONA SÁ (CONT'D)
(to Sara) Did you invite him?

SARA
No! He wasn't invited--

Dona Sá raises her voice.

DONA SÁ
Then what the hell are you doing here?

People around turn their attention to them. Ricardo sees the scene from the distance.

MANU
I--

DONA SÁ (CONT'D)
Leave! No one wants you here.

Manu looks down. Sara stares at him with pity.

DONA SÁ (CONT'D)
Did you hear me?

SARA
That's enough, mom. He's gonna leave now.

Sara looks at Manu.

SARA (CONT'D)
Right, Manu?

He stays quiet. Sara holds Dona Sá's arm and they walk away.

Manu looks around. All eyes are on him. His eyes meet Ricardo's.

CUT TO:

INT/EXT. MEMORIAL SALON BATHROOM - NIGHT

Manu STORMS into the bathroom, shutting the door behind him.

BANG! BANG! BANG!

He PUNCHES the walls multiple times, his fists getting bloodier with each hit.

He FALLS down. Tears roll down his cheeks.

A KNOCK.

RICARDO (O.S.)
Manu?

Manu quickly wipes his tears.

MANU
Give me a minute.

Manu sees Ricardo's shadow sit down from under the door.

RICARDO (O.S.)
There's this woman I knew, a long time ago. She lost someone she really loved unexpectedly one day, and her life was never the same. People always told her that time healed, but for her, it was the opposite. It only made it worse. They had a routine together, and without him there, everything she did felt incomplete. Her and I were very close, so I know how this can affect someone.

A beat.

RICARDO (O.S.) (CONT'D)
What I'm trying to say Manu, is that I see you in her. This process is different for everybody, but it's never easy, especially going through it alone. In her case, she needed to spend some time away with people who got her... And I think you might need that too.

Ricardo takes a deep breath.

RICARDO (CONT'D)
There's this place called 'Limbo'. I know people there. They would be happy to help you.

Manu shakes his head.

MANU
I don't need to be sent away to some stupid retreat Ricardo.

RICARDO (O.S.)
It's not a--

MANU (CONT'D)
I'm fine. I've been doing just fine.

Beat.

MANU (CONT'D)
It's been a long day, that's all. I'll be out in a second.

Manu sees Ricardo's shadow disappear.

He looks around. He reaches for a flask from his suit. Manu looks at it. Impulsively, he drinks.

INT. CHURCH - NIGHT

The bathroom door BURSTS open. Manu stumbles on his feet as he comes out.

Ricardo rushes toward him, concerned.

RICARDO
What took you so long?

MANU
Where is she?

RICARDO
Where is who?

Manu looks around. His gaze turns to the main altar. On it, a woman gives an inaudible speech.

WOMAN #1
...It's just what she did. And we would always follow her around. She was just the coolest. We... I miss her every day.

He leaves Ricardo and runs up the stage.

He takes the microphone out of the woman's hands. Some people gasp. The woman annoyingly leaves the stage.

MANU
Hey. Good night everybody.

Dona Sá sits motionless. Sara looks at him horrified. Her eyes meet Ricardo's. They walk toward each other.

MANU (CONT'D)
I'm Manu, as some of you may or may not know. Actually, now that I think about it, the majority of you don't. Because in the four years that I spent with Ema, I've never seen ninety percent of you.

Sara meets Ricardo.

SARA
Get him out of the fucking stage!

RICARDO
How am I supposed--

SARA
I don't care, just get him out!

MANU
I prepared a speech, but I don't remember exactly how I wrote it. I think it goes something like "Good evening ladies and gentlemen..."

He laughs.

MANU (CONT'D)
Sorry. It's not funny. I don't know why I'm laughing.

People murmur in confusion.

SARA
Is he drunk?

MANU
It's not funny at all. If it was funny I wouldn't cry every night for a year. And to be quite frank, I don't think I'll ever stop crying.

His voice shakes.

Dona Sá stands up and walks towards the exist. Some people around her start doing the same. Manu looks at her.

MANU (CONT'D)
Dona Sá--

SARA
Oh, no...

Dona Sá stops and looks at him. Her eyes filled with tears.

Sara runs to the speaker.

MANU
I wish I could switch places with her--

Sara turns off the speaker.

A GUARD goes up to the stage and grabs Manu by his arm. He does not fight back.

Ricardo grabs his phone and dials a number.

EXT. CHURCH - NIGHT

ROSA (33), intimidating but caring, runs out of her car.

She meets Ricardo, who stands outside of the salon.

ROSA
Where is he?

RICARDO
I think he left. I can't find his car.

ROSA
I fucking told him not to come. Did you try to call him?

RICARDO
Multiple times.

ROSA
FUCK!

Rosa grabs her cell phone and dials Manu's number.

INT. MANU'S CAR - NIGHT

Manu declines Rosa's call. He drives recklessly as he cleans the tears that roll down his face.

The neighborhood he drives in looks mostly dark, with no one to be seen.

He parks in front of a sketchy street. Manu looks at it for a few seconds. He steps out of the car.

EXT. ALLEY - CONTINUOUS

Manu walks aimlessly down the dark alley. He spots three guys who stand by the end of it. They smoke and laugh.

INT. ROSA'S CAR - NIGHT

Rosa drives with Ricardo in the passenger seat. Ricardo tries to call Manu.

ROSA
Any luck?

Ricardo shakes his head.

ROSA (CONT'D)
I'm gonna call 911.

RICARDO
No, don't--

ROSA
I'm not taking any risks, he's driving around drunk.

Beat.

ROSA (CONT'D)
Are there any specific spots that he goes for... you know.

Ricardo ponders.

RICARDO
I might know where he is.

Rosa looks at him.

EXT. ALLEY - NIGHT

The three guys grow silent as Manu approaches them.

GUY #1
Can we help you?

MANU
What do you have?

GUY #1
I'm sorry?!

MANU
You know exactly what I'm talking about.

The three look at each other, suspiciously.

GUY #2
Do you have a problem, buddy?

The three make a circle around him. Manu's phone rings.

GUY #1
Are you with the police or something?

Manu holds Guy #1's t-shirt. The other two JUMP on him right away.

Guy #3 holds Manu while Guy #1 SMACKS him in the face and stomach. Manu falls.

The three gather around him as he tries to stand up. They KICK him. Again. Again. Again.

Manu groans in pain.

RICARDO (O.S.)
Manu?

The three guys stop and look at each other. They jump over a wall by the end of the street and run away. Manu moans on the floor.

Rosa and Ricardo walk down the alley. Rosa gasps when she sees him. The two help Manu stand up.

INT. MANU'S APARTMENT - NIGHT

Piles of clothes cover the dirty couch. Food leftovers from weeks ago lay on the table. Silverware rests on the kitchen sink collecting cockroaches.

Ricardo sits Manu on the sofa. Rosa stares at them.

Manu avoids eye contact.

ROSA
I told you--

MANU
For fucks sake--

ROSA (CONT'D)
I told you not to go! Why would you want to be around people who don't even like you?

MANU
I wasn't there for them--

ROSA
People who don't even care about you--

MANU
I was there for Ema!

ROSA
Ema is DEAD Manu! She's gone!

Manu finally looks up at her. Ricardo glances back and forth between them.

ROSA (CONT'D)
And I'm sorry that that's hard for you, and I'm sorry that you were there. But she is gone now. You can't change that!

Rosa sits by his side.

ROSA (CONT'D)
But you are not gone, you are here. You went to rehab, you have a chance to start over! Just to throw it all away now? For what? I mean, look at this place!

Manu stands up.

ROSA (CONT'D)
Instead of getting your shit together you just--

MANU
I just WHAT?

Manu raises his voice. Rosa grows silent.

MANU (CONT'D)
Last time I checked I didn't ask for your fucking opinion.

Beat.

MANU (CONT'D)
You're not Mom, you'll never be Mom. So stop acting like you are.

RICARDO
Manu--

MANU
Go take care of your own life, which frankly you should be putting more work on.

Rosa stands up.

ROSA
You need help.

MANU
Thank you for stating the fucking obvious. I wouldn't know that!

ROSA
Fuck you.

Rosa walks to the door.

ROSA (CONT'D)
Get your shit together Manu. I won't always be here to clean after you.

Rosa SHUTS the door behind her.

MANU
Bitch.

Manu sits down in pain. Ricardo sadly stares at him and stands up.

RICARDO
Call me if you need anything.

Manu does not respond. Ricardo leaves.

INT. MANU'S LIVING ROOM - DAY

Manu folds his clothes in the living room. He stops and looks around. It looks better than yesterday.

He grabs his phone. He goes down his contact list and stops at Rosa's name. Manu hesitates before pressing "Call".

RING. RING. RING.

Voice mail.

He looks at his call history. It's his ninth attempt.

Manu sits on the couch and grabs his laptop. He searches for "Limbo".

Nothing comes up.

He then tries "Limbo retreat". Nothing. He frowns.

INT. COFFEE SHOP - DAY

Manu and Ricardo sit in a corner of a coffee shop.

MANU
Were you there too?

RICARDO
Yeah. We both lived there for a while.

MANU
What were you there for?

Ricardo hesitates.

RICARDO
I was just going through a lot back then.

Beat.

MANU
And how was it?

RICARDO
I can't really talk about it, but--

Ricardo lowers his voice.

RICARDO (CONT'D)
It changed my life. It gave me another chance.

Ricardo takes out a piece of paper and hands it to Manu.

RICARDO (CONT'D)
They will be waiting for you.

Manu looks at the paper. It has a geographic coordinate on it.

FADE OUT.

FADE IN:

INT. MANU'S CAR - DAY

Manu drives to the sound of '*Tchitchirote*'. Around him, the only life that can be seen are trees. They vary in shades of green as he goes up the mountain. He sings along to the song.

Something catches his attention through the rearview mirror. A PURPLE FIGURE. He turns the volume down.

Manu takes another glance, but the silhouette is gone. He dismisses it and speeds away.

The same purple figure runs into the bushes. Manu does not see it this time.

EXT. WOODS - DAY

Manu stops the car. He looks at his map. It's the right place.

He steps out of the car with his suitcase and takes a look around. He walks further away from the car with a confused look on his face.

He's in the middle of nowhere.

JORGE
Mr. Barbosa?

Manu JUMPS to the sound of the voice.

He quickly turns around to see JORGE (9), scarily adorable, with a big smile. He wears rags.

JORGE (CONT'D)
I'm sorry. I didn't mean to scare you. Are you Mr. Barbosa?

MANU
Y-yes. It's okay--

JORGE
I'm Jorge! I'm from Limbo.

MANU
Oh.

Manu looks around.

MANU (CONT'D)
Are you here all by yourself?

JORGE
I'm here to take you home, Mister.

Manu takes a great look at the kid. Jorge does not break eye contact or stop smiling.

MANU
Sure. We can go.

JORGE
Follow me.

Jorge signals him. Manu hesitantly follows.

He doesn't notice that his tires have been punctured.

INT. ROSA'S LIVING ROOM - DAY

Rosa paces back and forth in the living room holding her phone in her ear. She's sent to voicemail.

ROSA
Fuck me.

She takes a deep breath before grabbing her car keys.

EXT. MANU'S APARTMENT - DAY

Rosa rings the bell. She stands for a while waiting. Nothing. She tries again... nothing.

She looks through the window. The apartment looks completely dark. She raises her voice.

ROSA
Manu?

No response. She looks around and notices the empty spot in the parking lot.

EXT. LIMBO MAIN STREET - DAY

A gate OPENS to Limbo. Manu follows Jorge along the empty streets.

The cabins all look the same. Small, made of cement, not painted, typical of poor countryside areas in Cape Verde.

From inside the cabins and behind the curtains, people observe Manu with curiosity.

Jorge runs toward LANA (54), cold and erratic, who waits for them by the end of the street. Her expression lines form a grave look.

Jorge hugs her leg. She does not break eye contact with Manu.

LANA
Welcome, Mr. Barbosa.

MANU
Thank you, Mrs.--

LANA
Lana.

Manu smiles and looks around.

MANU
Pretty quiet, huh?

LANA
I'll take you to your accommodation.

Jorge, almost as in command, lets go of her leg and runs down the street.

INT. MANU'S CABIN - DAY

Lana enters, followed by Manu. It's a small space. The living room decoration is limited to a small table and pillows on top of a rug to improvise a couch. Besides the living room, the other two divisions of the cabin are a small bathroom and a bedroom.

LANA
Dinner is at 7 sharp. We dine in the tent by the end of the street. You'll meet Rui there. Access to electricity here is limited.

She raises her hand. Manu hesitantly gives her his phone.

LANA (CONT'D)
You'll have the right to one call a day, after dinner in our booth. For privacy reasons, do not to talk about our community. We like to keep it a safe and exclusive space.

MANU
Understood.

Manu puts his suitcase down and walks around the cabin.

LANA
No wandering around the streets before your welcoming ceremony. It's strictly prohibited. You're still an outsider.

Manu nods, dismissively.

LANA (CONT'D)
I'll see you at dinner, Mr. Barbosa. If you'll excuse me...

Lana leaves the cabin.

INT. MANU'S BEDROOM - CONTINUOUS

Manu steps into the bedroom. The furniture consists of a small dresser and a rug with pillows on top of it. A purple robe lays on it.

He grabs it and puts it on. Lana watches him through the window.

They LOCK eyes. Manu smiles and waves, but Lana simply walks away.

INT. RICARDO'S LIVING ROOM - NIGHT

Ricardo watches the news, bored.

KNOCK-KNOCK.

He frowns. He walks to the door and opens it.

RICARDO
Rosa?

Rosa rushes inside.

ROSA
Is Manu here?

RICARDO
Nice seeing you too.

He shuts the door behind him.

RICARDO (CONT'D)
And no, Manu is not here.

ROSA
Did you speak with him at all today?

RICARDO
No, why? Is something wrong?

ROSA
I've been trying to call him all day. And he's not in his place.

RICARDO
I'm sure he's ok.

ROSA
Do you have any idea of where he could be?

Ricardo shakes his head.

RICARDO
I'm sure he's ok.

ROSA
Why do you keep saying that?

RICARDO
Why are you so worried?

Rosa paces back and forth.

ROSA
He tried to call me a bunch of times and I didn't pick up.

She takes a deep breath.

ROSA (CONT'D)
Something doesn't feel right, Ricardo. He's been acting off lately but he's not the type to simply disappear.

Ricardo looks away.

RICARDO
I'll let you know if I hear anything from him.

Ricardo opens the door and invites her out.

EXT. LIMBO'S CAFETERIA - NIGHT

Manu approaches a big tent at the end of the street. As he gets closer, voices of laughter and conversation can be heard inside.

INT. LIMBO'S CAFETERIA - CONTINUOUS

Manu steps into the tent.

The room automatically grows silent. In unison, the crowd turns to him.

Manu looks at the clock close to the entrance. 7:05. He looks back at the crowd and forces a smile. No one smiles back. He locks eyes with Lana, who has an angry look on her face.

By her side sits RUI (50S), calculated, intimidating, and the only person in the room who smiles.

RUI
You may continue.

With that, everyone in the room turns away and continues their conversation as if it never stopped.

Manu spots an empty chair and sits down. Someone hands him a plate of soup. Rui does not break eye contact.

INT. LIMBO'S CAFETERIA - NIGHT

People leave the tent. Manu stands up to do the same.

LANA
You were late.

MANU
Only five minutes--

LANA
I said seven sharp.

RUI (O.S.)
Manu!

Rui approaches them. He goes for a handshake.

RUI (CONT'D)
It's a pleasure to finally meet you.

Manu shakes his hand.

RUI (CONT'D)
Join me for a walk.

Manu looks at Lana. She looks down and steps back.

EXT. LIMBO STREETS - NIGHT

Manu and Rui walk down the street. The dim lights contrasted with the moon give a dark but cozy feeling to the streets of Limbo.

Groups of kids run, play, and laugh. Groups of adults sit, stand, and chat.

A kid almost knocks Manu over. Manu smiles at the kid, but the kid does not smile back. He looks scared. Before Manu can say anything, the kid runs away.

RUI
The streets right before curfew always get busy.

MANU
Curfew?

RUI
Our 9 p.m. starts soon. We have a couple during the day. Different purposes.

Manu slowly nods. Rui has a dull, almost scary expression. His voice sounds calm.

RUI (CONT'D)
We like keeping things organized here. You get it, don't you?

MANU
I understand.

RUI
It takes a lot to take care of a family this big.

Manu looks around.

Every time they pass by a group, it automatically grows silent.

MANU
Did you build this place all by yourself?

RUI
I wouldn’t say so. Lana worked as hard or even harder for this place to be what it is today. I wouldn’t be anything without her. Or everyone here really.

They pass another group. The same thing happens. A beat.

RUI (CONT’D)
What brings you here, Manu?

Manu thinks for a moment.

MANU
I needed to get away from Praia.

RUI
I don’t blame you.

Rui stops walking, making Manu do the same.

RUI (CONT’D)
Manu, I hope you understand that we, as a community, have a hard time trusting outsiders.

Manu nods.

RUI (CONT’D)
We usually give newcomers a couple of days to decide if they want to stay or not.

Rui looks at Manu waiting for a response.

MANU
Oh, I--

RUI
No pressure. Just keep in mind that while you're here, being a member or not, there are certain rules you'll need to follow. That includes respecting our time.

Rui places his hand on Manu's shoulder and looks him deep in the eyes.

RUI (CONT'D)
I hope you decide to stay with us, Manu. I really do.

INT. ROSA'S LIVING ROOM - NIGHT

Rosa sits on her computer searching for car accident reports nearby.

Her phone RINGS. She jumps out of her seat. Unknown number.

ROSA
Hello?

MANU (V.O)
Rosa?

Rosa falls back on the couch in relief.

INT. PHONE BOOTH - NIGHT

Manu stands alone in the phone booth.

MANU
Rosa, are you there?

INTERCUT - PHONE CONVERSATION

ROSA
Manu, where the fuck have you been?

MANU
I'm sorry, I tried to call you--

ROSA
I know. It's fine. Are you ok? Where are you?

MANU
I'm ok. I--

Manu looks in both directions.

MANU (CONT'D)
I can't really say.

ROSA
What?

Rosa stands up again.

MANU
Look, I'm fine ok?! You don't need to worry.

ROSA
How do you expect me not to?

Manu sighs. He looks around and lowers his voice.

MANU
I'm in this retreat called Limbo.

ROSA
What the hell? Why are you in a retreat?

MANU
Ricardo recommended it to me. I know it sounds ridiculous but--

ROSA
Ricardo? Does Ricardo know you're there?

MANU
Yeah...Look--

Rosa frowns in confusion.

MANU (CONT'D)
I don't know if I'm gonna stay anyway. It's kinda weird out here. I'll probably be back in a couple of days. Ok?

INT. RUI'S CABIN - SAME TIME

Rui and Lana listen to the phone conversation. Rui appears calm. Lana fumes.

ROSA (V.O.)
Just...Be careful.

MANU (V.O.)
I know how to take care of myself.

ROSA (V.O.)
Sure you do.

MANU (V.O.)
I gotta go now, talk to you soon.

ROSA (V.O.)
Manu--

The line cuts.

INT. ROSA'S LIVING ROOM - CONTINUOUS

Rosa puts the phone down and stays motionless for a few seconds.

She grabs her laptop and opens Facebook. She searches for "RICARDO SANTOS". An account with no profile picture or posts comes up.

Her gaze turns to the place of work. "*Bar Sofia*".

INT. MANU'S CABIN - NIGHT

Manu WAKES UP with a loud BANG noise. An incandescent yellow light shines through the window, reminiscent of a fire.

He quickly stands up and walks towards it to see.

BANG!

He steps back.

EXT. LIMBO STREETS - CONTINUOUS

Manu walks outside and looks in all directions for the source of the light.

Smoke comes from a few blocks away. Manu looks back at the cabin. Hesitantly, he decides to follow the commotion.

EXT. LIMBO PARK - NIGHT

The noise grows louder as Manu gets closer to the light.

SHADOWS pass close to him. He quickly hides behind a cabin. His eyes meet a big tree. He collects courage before running to hide behind it. He takes a deep breath before leaning over to see the crowd.

The group of about forty people stands in two parallel lines. The lines face each other, with about 13 feet separating them. Everyone wears a purple robe and a faceless white mask.

Perpendicular to the crowd, up on a stage, stands Rui and Lana. Their robes are red, and neither of them wears a mask. By their side, someone periodically beats a big drum.

BANG! BANG! BANG--

Rui raises his hand and the drum STOPS. The DRUMMER bows to him before running down the passage formed by the crowd. Everyone stays motionless when...

A SCREAM echoes.

Manu looks back to see SOMEONE masked being dragged down the aisle by two other masked people. This person, different from everybody else, wears a white long dress.

The screams turn to cries as they get closer to the main stage.

The crowd HUMS a static melody in unison. Manu is in dismay.

They approach the end of the two lines. The crowd turns to the stage.

LANA
SILENCE!

The humming STOPS.

Rui nods at the two people who carry the person in the white dress.

They nod back and take the person's mask off.

It's Sandra.

EXT. LIMBO PARK - CONTINUOUS

Sandra has a black eye, with her entire face filled with bruises. Fresh blood comes out of her nose, mixed with snot.

Her tired eyes are red, filled with tears.

SANDRA
Please...Please don't--

Her voice sounds weak. Rui and Lana slowly come down the stage.

Rui looks Sandra deep in the eyes. He gestures to the other two to let her go.

She falls to her knees in front of him.

Lana walks behind her and pushes Sandra's hair back, making her look Rui directly in the eyes.

RUI
Anything else you wanna say, Sandra?

Sandra collects all her strength to look around. Her gaze stops at Dolores.

Dolores sits way back on the stage in her wheelchair, motionless.

SANDRA
Rui, please. I'm all she has--

Lana SLAPS her. The noise makes Manu jump. Sandra falls back.

LANA
You ungrateful BITCH!

Sandra cries in pain.

LANA (CONT'D)
After everything this family did for you. You were going to put us all at risk for--

RUI
That's enough Lana.

LANA
But Rui--

RUI
I said, ENOUGH!

Lana SPITS on Sandra. She steps away and stands behind Rui.

Rui leans over to Sandra, who tries to sit down again.

RUI (CONT'D)
Everything I've ever done, I've done for your happiness.

He points at Dolores.

RUI (CONT'D)
For both of you.

SANDRA
OUR happiness? Look at her!

Sandra's voice trembles.

SANDRA (CONT'D)
Does she look happy to you?

LANA
How dare you--

Rui gestures for Lana to stop. He does not break eye contact with Sandra.

RUI
Every prize comes with a sacrifice.
You knew that.

He leans over and kisses the top of Sandra's head.

RUI (CONT'D)
Don't worry about Dolores. We'll
take care of her.

SANDRA
No Rui, please--RUI!

The two people come back to hold her as Rui and Lana walk back up to the stage.

They put Sandra's mask on again. Sandra continues to scream.

Lana grabs a bow and an arrow.

RUI'S PRAYER IN LATIN.

RUI
Pray, brothers and sisters, that my
sacrifice and yours may be
acceptable to Him, our powerful
Master.

CROWD
Pray, brothers and sisters, that my
sacrifice and yours may be
acceptable to Him, our powerful
Master.

Lana walks down the stage.

RUI
May the Master accept the sacrifice from our hands for the praise and glory of his name.

CROWD (O.C.)
May the Master accept the sacrifice from our hands for the praise and glory of his name.

Lana stands with the arrow now in the bow. She carefully aims at Sandra.

Sandra sobs uncontrollably. Manu has tears in his eyes.

Complete silence...

RUI
Surculus.

The arrow PIERCES through Sandra's head. Her screams cease.

Her body stands still for a second before... it falls back, lifeless.

Everyone shouts. The screams are of agony.

Rui cleans a tear that rolls down his eyes.

Manu slowly steps back, shaking. Completely out of sight, he sprints away.

INT. MANU’S CABIN - NIGHT

Manu STORMS into the cabin in tears. He desperately looks around, before running toward his suitcase.

He takes everything out of it with his trembling hands. His frantic gaze softens as he hears the sound of his keys.

EXT. LIMBO PARK - CONTINUOUS

Sandra’s body lays on the floor surrounded by a pool of blood. The arrow is still stuck in her head.

The crowd stands in silence now. No one wears a mask on anymore and they all look up to the sky.

Rui has his eyes closed and breathes heavily. Lana stands by his side.

LANA
What is it? What's wrong?

Rui opens his eyes.

RUI
The outsider.

EXT. LIMBO STREETS - NIGHT

Manu RUNS up the street toward the entrance of the fence. He stumbles on his feet and looks back several times.

He approaches the gate. The doors are closed. He tries to open them. Locked. He gets agitated.

Manu kicks the doors multiple times with all his strength, in vain. He looks up the fence. It is covered in barbwire.

He places his shaking hands on his head and closes his eyes.

MANU
No, no, no, no--

Manu looks up at the fence again.

EXT. LIMBO PARK - CONTINUOUS

Lana stands agitated by Rui's side.

LANA
Should we do something?

RUI
Shh--

Rui looks up at the sky.

EXT. OTHER SIDE OF THE FENCE - NIGHT

Manu falls on the other side, letting go of a muffled scream of pain.

The moonlight reveals a huge deep cut on his leg.

Manu quickly takes out his cardigan and tears it up. He grabs the pieces and wraps them around his wound, swallowing the pain.

He stands up and palpates his pockets. No keys.

MANU
Fuck!

Manu kneels on the ground, madly and blindly looking for them.

MANU (CONT'D)
C'mon, c'mon--

He touches something and stops. He starts laughing. It's the keys.

MANU (CONT'D)
Thank God, thank you! Thank you!

Manu kisses the keys. He stands up and limps away.

EXT. LIMBO PARK - CONTINUOUS

Rui stares at the crowd. They attentively stare back.

Lana paces back and forth behind him.

RUI
I want him alive.

Rui nods to the crowd.

RUI (CONT'D)
Go.

Half of the crowd puts their masks back on and runs away in every direction. Their movements are animalistic.

The other half stays still.

RUI (CONT'D)
For you, it's curfew time.

The crowd looks around at each other.

LANA
You heard him. Back to your cabins, now!

The group starts separating.

LANA (CONT'D)
And may this serve as a warning to all of you.

Lana points at Sandra's body. People continue to walk back to their cabins.

MATILDA (26), stops midway and looks back at Sandra's body. She has tears in her eyes.

INT. BAR - NIGHT

Ricardo places vodka bottles in a big safe. BEA (30), the life of the party, walks toward him with two cupcakes.

BEA
The last two.

He laughs.

RICARDO
You were quick today.

Ricardo eats one. He makes exaggeratedly satisfied noises. Bea laughs.

BEA
Wanna do something after?

RICARDO
Like...

BEA
Like, get a drink.

RICARDO
Oh, I don't drink.

BEA
What do you mean? You're a bartender!

RICARDO
I'm sober. A year now.

A KNOCK on the window.

Bea and Ricardo look toward it. It's Rosa. Ricardo freezes.

BEA
(to Rosa) We're closed!

ROSA
Ricardo! I need to talk to Ricardo.

BEA
(to Ricardo) Do you know her?

Ricardo rolls his eyes and walks over to open the door. Rosa rushes inside.

ROSA
Manu called.

RICARDO
Is he ok?

ROSA
He’s in Limbo.

He looks away.

ROSA (CONT’D)
You know, the place you told him about.

Ricardo starts to walk away to the bar. Rosa follows him.

RICARDO
Look, I couldn’t say anything.

ROSA
Bullshit! You knew I was worried and didn’t tell me anyway.

Bea walks to them.

BEA
Is everything ok, Ricardo?

RICARDO
Yeah, this is just my friend’s sis--

Ricardo stops. He lowers his eyebrows and squeezes his eyes. Rosa and Bea look at him. Ricardo starts breathing heavily.

BEA
Ricardo? Are you ok?

He turns his back to them.

RICARDO
Yes, I--

He clenches his hand.

RICARDO (CONT’D)
Excuse me.

Ricardo runs past them.

INT. BAR BATHROOM - CONTINUOUS

Rick closes the bathroom door. The world spins around him. He kneels by the toilet and throws up.

A knock on the door.

BEA (V.O.)
Ricardo?

Ricardo's eyes widen. He PUNCHES the wall, containing the pain.

He sits with his back against the wall. He breathes slowly with his eyes closed, cleaning the tears that roll down.

INT. BAR - NIGHT

Ricardo storms out of the bathroom. Rosa and Bea sit together by the bar.

Rosa stands up as he gets closer to them.

ROSA
Sorry, I didn't mean to--

He walks past her.

RICARDO
Bea, let's go get a drink.

EXT. WOODS - NIGHT

Limbo looks distant now. Manu runs as fast as he can through trees and bushes, with the only source of light being the moon and stars.

He keeps looking down on a path built of footsteps and tire tracks, all made by those who visited Limbo before him.

A smile of relief forms as his car reflects the moonlight.

INT/ EXT. MANU'S CAR - NIGHT

Manu shuts the car door. He places the key in the ignition. He turns it on but... nothing happens.

MANU
What the--

He tries again. Nothing. He presses the pedal. Nothing.

Manu opens the car door and steps out. Now with the car light on, he sees that the tires have been punctured.

He opens the hood. They burned everything inside.

Manu sits outside next to the car, blankly.

FOOTSTEPS approach. He gets taken out of his trance.

EXT. WOODS - NIGHT

MARIO (20), erratic and violent, walks swiftly, followed by CATI (17), bitchy and calm, and KENDALL (17), sarcastic but empathetic.

CATI
Can you slow down Mario?

MARIO
I know I heard something.

KENDALL
Probably just an animal...

MARIO
A-HA!

Mario sprints toward Manu's car.

MARIO (CONT'D)
I fucking told you!

He examines the car as the other two meet him.

MARIO (CONT'D)
He's probably close by. Cati, take a look around.

CATI
Do I look like I take orders from you?

MARIO
Not from me, from Rui. You saw what happened to Sandra.

Manu hides inside one of the bushes covering his mouth.

CATI
Yeah, that was--

MARIO
Fucking awesome!

KENDALL
I wouldn’t call someone being murdered “fucking awesome”.

MARIO
She had it coming.

The other two look at each other.

MARIO (CONT’D)
What? It wasn’t the first time she broke the rules.

KENDALL
I just feel bad for Dolores.

MARIO
Is being an empath your new personality trait Kendall?

Cati walks around looking for footprints.

CATI
Now she’ll probably be sent away.

She finds some and starts walking toward Manu’s hiding spot.

MARIO
Rui should kill her already, spare her the pain.

KENDALL
C’mon man--

MARIO
What? It’s not like she’s of any use.

KENDALL
Still.

The boys quiet down when their eyes meet Cati’s. She has her pointing finger in the middle of her lips.

The same finger slowly points down at one of the bushes.

They surround the bush, each a few feet away. Manu holds his breath.

CATI
You’re trapped. Make this easier for you and step out.

MARIO
You heard Cati. Or make this harder for you and we'll blow your head off.

No response. They stare at each other.

MARIO (CONT'D)
Well, you give us no choice.

Mario aggressively jumps to the bush, followed by Cati and Kendall.

Manu RISES from a bush on the other side. He quietly SPRINTS away into the woods.

Kendall hears footsteps and raises his head. He watches as Manu's silhouette disappears into the night.

KENDALL
GUYS!

The other two stand up and look in his direction. Cati takes a deep breath.

MARIO
I got this. Should I give him an advance?

EXT. WOODS - CONTINUOUS

Manu limps through the branches and thorns. He breathes heavily, repeatedly glancing back. Fast footsteps follow him.

He TRIPS, falling on his injured leg. He swallows a scream. The footsteps keep getting closer.

MARIO (O.S.)
You're just wasting your energy *outie*.

Manu stands up. He tries to run again, but his wounded leg keeps him on the ground. He desperately looks around.

EXT. WOODS - CONTINUOUS

Mario whistles as he marches in the darkness. He stops and smirks.

MARIO
This is getting ridiculous, man.

He wanders around, leaning down on every bush.

MARIO (CONT'D)
You're lucky Rui wants you alive.
For whatever reason.

Manu lies prone on a branch. He holds it tight, shivering.

MARIO (CONT'D)
If he didn't, I would probably just
kill you right now.

INT. LIMBO CABIN - NIGHT

Lana lights the fire. Dolores sits blank-eyed in her wheelchair. Their eyes meet.

LANA
Don't look at me like that.

She walks past Dolores and opens the drawers. Lana starts taking out clothes.

LANA (CONT'D)
Rui was nothing but patient with
all of Sandra's disobedience.

She grabs a suitcase and places the clothes inside.

LANA (CONT'D)
It's all over now. Not that you
would know anyway.

Lana closes the suitcase and puts it aside. She carries Dolores out of her wheelchair and lays her in bed.

LANA (CONT'D)
We'll figure out what to do with
you tomorrow.

She takes one last cold look at Dolores before leaving the cabin.

Dolores faces the ceiling. Tears roll down her cheeks.

EXT. WOODS - NIGHT

Mario continues his search, now looking behind the trees.

MARIO
Come out, come out, wherever you
are.

He STOPS underneath Manu's branch and looks around. Mario takes a deep breath and closes his eyes. His smirk has now faded.

MARIO (O.S.) (CONT'D)
I'm getting annoyed here, *outie*.

Manu HOLDS his breath.

Mario's footsteps get further away. Manu looks down and tracks him with his eyes. His arms slowly give in.

Manu FALLS, letting out a muffled groan. He holds the pain in and rapidly touches the ground, looking for something. He finds a sharp stick and smiles in relief.

Manu stands up and prepares to run.

CATI
Where do--

He TURNS startled to see Cati and Kendall. Impulsively, he grabs the stick and PIERCES Cati in the stomach.

Cati SCREAMS. She falls to her knees with her hand covering the wound.

KENDALL
Cati!

Kendall kneels by her side and moves her hand away. It's full of blood! MANU stares at them, paralyzed.

KENDALL (CONT'D)
What the hell did you do?

Manu slowly walks back. Kendall does not look at him.

Before Manu can run, Mario SPRINTS toward him, KNOCKING him onto the floor.

Mario, who now sits on top of Manu, HITS him in the face. Manu bleeds through his nose with the impact.

PUNCH. PUNCH. PUNCH.

With each hit, the noise in the background gets further and further away.

KENDALL (CONT'D)
Mario that's enough! MARIO!

Manu's vision gets blurry.

Mario’s maniac face stands close to his. He can almost see a smile.

INT. RUI’S CABIN - DAY

Manu’s eyes OPEN. He breathes heavily as if he just woke up from a nightmare. He looks around the room in desperation when the pain HITS.

He touches his head and looks at his hand. It is covered in blood.

Manu glimpses at the door and attempts to leave the bed. His legs do not move.

RUI (O.S.)
Not so fast.

Manu looks at Rui, who sits in a corner watching him.

MANU
What did you do to me?

Rui strides to him.

RUI
We couldn’t take any more risks with you.

He sits at the corner of the bed.

MANU
Did you kill that woman?

Rui laughs.

MANU (CONT’D)
ANSWER ME!

Rui’s smile fades. He gets closer to Manu, looking him deep in the eyes. Their noses almost touch.

RUI
Who do you think you’re talking to?

Manu shrinks.

RUI (CONT’D)
I thought I made myself clear when I told you about how this community works.

Rui rises.

RUI (CONT'D)
Yet, you decided to disobey me.

Rui turns his back to Manu. A pause, when...

He turns and violently GRABS Manu's neck.

RUI (CONT'D)
You think you have the right, after all of that, to come here and disrespect me?

Manu chokes. He tries to pull his hands off of him. Rui squeezes even harder.

MANU
Please, let me go. Ple--

Rui lets go of Manu's neck. Manu catches his breath while Rui paces back and forth.

RUI
Why did you come here, Manu?

Beat.

RUI (CONT'D)
Is it because of Ema?

Manu freezes.

RUI (CONT'D)
You cannot get over her?

MANU
How do you know about Ema?

Rui smirks.

RUI
You cannot get over the fact that she died in your arms?

MANU
Stop.

RUI
That you might be the reason she's dead now?

Manu tries to stand up again, unsuccessfully.

RUI (CONT'D)
Maybe if you had never convinced her to try them in the first place...

Manu gives up. Tears of rage roll down his face.

RUI (CONT'D)
Maybe if you were sober that day...

Beat.

RUI (CONT'D)
Maybe she would still be here.

MANU
Did Ricardo tell you all of that?

BAM!

Rui punches the walls. Manu stares at him in awe. Rui yells.

RUI
You don't get the point, do you? I don't need anyone to tell me about ANYTHING!

He looks at Manu.

RUI (CONT'D)
Why do you think these people are here, huh?

Manu shakes his head.

RUI (CONT'D)
Because I give them what they want. And people do anything to have what they want.

Rui walks over to Manu again and kneels by his side.

RUI (CONT'D)
I know what you want, Manu. I just need to know if you are willing to do what it takes to have it.

Manu looks back at Rui, mesmerized.

INT. RICARDO'S ROOM - DAY

Bea wakes up with a smile on her face. Without opening her eyes, she stretches her arms to the other side of the bed. Empty. Her joy turns to confusion.

She leaves the bed and walks around the room. The room is neat, with minimal decoration.

Bea walks over some picture frames that hang on the wall. She smiles at the photos of a young Ricardo with his family and friends. Her face drops when she sees a photo of Ricardo kissing another WOMAN. Bea grabs the frame and examines it.

She puts it down and opens a drawer. Inside of it, more pictures. She grabs some of them. She gets even more confused when she notices that none of them are of Ricardo. They're of Manu.

RICARDO (O.S)
What are you doing?

Bea jumps, closing the drawer behind her.

BEA
You scared the shit out of me.

Ricardo frowns when he sees the frame on the table behind her.

RICARDO
What do you have there?

Bea grabs the frame as Ricardo rushes toward her. His face grows grave when he sees the picture.

BEA
Oh, I found--

He snaps it out of Bea's hand.

RICARDO
Don't go through my stuff.

He puts it back on the wall.

BEA
Sorry, I was just looking around.

Ricardo looks away.

BEA (CONT'D)
Was she your girlfriend?

Ricardo glances at her, blue.

RICARDO
I knew this was a mistake.

BEA
Excuse me?

He walks past Bea and collects some clothes on the floor. Ricardo throws the clothes at her.

RICARDO
Let's forget this ever happened, ok?

BEA
But Ricardo--

RICARDO
Just leave, Bea.

Bea stares at him, incredulous. Ricardo looks away. She walks out of the room, slamming the door behind her.

EXT. LIMBO PARK - DAY

The crowd gathers close to the central stage. Mario talks inaudibly to a small group in the back. Matilda listens right behind him.

Kendall and Cati stand next to each other in the front row. Cati has bandages wrapped around her belly.

Everyone immediately grows silent when Rui and Lana enter the stage. Manu walks behind them. Mario smiles malevolently when he sees him.

LANA
Bonum mane.

CROWD
Bonum mane.

LANA
We have a few announcements for you this morning--

Rui interrupts her.

RUI
I'll take it from here, Lana.

Lana embarrassingly steps back and lowers her head.

RUI (CONT'D)
I have great news. Tonight, we will be welcoming a new member to our family.

Rui claps. The crowd awkwardly follows. Cati and Kendall look at each other confused.

Mario has a deadpan expression. Matilda examines Manu, who stands stoic in the back.

RUI (CONT'D)
Manu will be a part of this community, so be sure to treat him as such.

Mario looks down.

RUI (CONT'D)
Now, some not-so-happy news. Dolores will be going away tonight after the ceremony.

People murmur.

RUI (CONT'D)
I know, I know. But now, without Sandra, her help will be best used elsewhere.

The murmur grows into chatter.

EXT. LIMBO STREETS - DAY

Mario rushes to Kendall and Cati, interrupting their conversation.

MARIO
Why the hell would he do that?

KENDALL
Who knows.

Mario paces back and forth.

KENDALL (CONT'D)
Why do you care so much?

MARIO
Because he usually just snaps their heads off.

Beat.

MARIO (CONT'D)
Am I the only one intrigued?

CATI
Maybe he was in a good mood.

Mario scoffs.

MARIO
I see what you're doing here.
You'll regret this.

Mario starts to walk away.

CATI
What did I do?

Mario lifts his middle finger at them. He BUMPS into Matilda, making her fall.

MARIO
Watch your step, *humie*.

Mario sprints away, annoyed. Matilda rolls her eyes and stands up.

KENDALL
Ignore him, Matilda, he's having a bad day.

Matilda ignores Kendall and continues to walk.

CATI
I'm sorry about Sandra.

She stops. She does not look back.

CATI (CONT'D)
I know you guys were *very* close.

Matilda hesitates before rushing away.

MATILDA
Bitch.

EXT. CABIN - DAY

Matilda stands motionless in front of a cabin. Her eyes are filled with tears.

She tries the door. It's open. She cleans her tears and puts on a fake smile before stepping in.

EXT. BAR - NIGHT

Bea stands against the wall, smoking a cigarette. Her gaze meets Rosa, who rushes into the bar.

She quickly puts out the cigarette.

INT. BAR - CONTINUOUS

Bea enters the bar and looks around. Rosa sits alone in a corner. She seems to be looking for somebody.

Bea confidently approaches her.

BEA
Are you looking for Ricardo?

This catches Rosa by surprise.

ROSA
How do you--

Bea sits down. Rosa's face lightens.

ROSA (CONT'D)
I remember you.

BEA
He's not here today.

Rosa seems disappointed.

ROSA
Do you have any idea of where he might be?

Bea shakes her head.

ROSA (CONT'D)
Well. Thank you anyway.

Rosa stands up.

BEA
Wait!

Rosa stops.

BEA (CONT'D)
Did your brother get into contact again?

Beat.

ROSA
No.

Bea gets agitated.

BEA
Look, this might seem weird but--

ROSA
What?

BEA
Can I see a picture of your brother?

Rosa slowly reaches for her phone.

BEA (CONT'D)
Yeah...

Rosa opens a picture of her and Manu and shows it to Bea. She grows pale.

BEA (CONT'D)
There's something you should know.

INT. RUI'S CABIN - NIGHT

Manu sits on the bed, wearing a purple robe. His gaze is distant. The clock TICKS in the background, with the silence around making it sound louder.

Rui enters the room. He wears the same robe but in the color red.

RUI
Ready?

Manu nods, not looking at him. Rui places his hand on Manu's shoulder.

RUI (CONT'D)
Every prize comes with a sacrifice.

Rui smiles and exits. Manu stands up and looks at a photo that lies on the bed next to him. It's of him and Ema at their graduation ceremony.

He stares at it for a few seconds before he walks out of the cabin.

EXT. LIMBO PARK - NIGHT

The crowd stands in a circle. Everyone wears a purple robe and a white mask with no face. Rui stands outside the circle.

Lana arrives, breathless. Rui does not look at her as she stands by his side. She wears a red robe and carries a book.

RUI
What took you so long?

LANA
She's dead.

Rui turns to her.

RUI
Who is?

LANA
Dolores.

Rui closes his fists and shuts his eyes.

RUI
And how did this happen?

LANA
I don't know--

RUI
Well, find out!

He takes a deep breath and lowers his voice again.

RUI (CONT'D)
She was under your watch. Find out who did this.

Lana nods.

Rui walks toward the circle, which opens upon his arrival. A big drawing of a star can be seen in the middle. Rui and Lana stand right in front of it.

RUI (CONT'D)
Incipiemus.

Manu comes from the other end of the circle, followed by two masked members. The circle opens allowing him to walk in. Manu stops in the middle of a star drawn on the floor.

RUI (CONT'D)
Undress.

Manu slowly takes off the robe. He kneels in front of them, naked. Lana grabs a golden knife from inside the robe and draws an “X” on Manu’s back. Manu shuts his eyes in pain.

RUI (CONT’D)
Tonight, Limbo welcomes a new member.

People hold hands and raise them in the air. They hum a low and continuous note in unison.

Lana opens the book. Rui steps forward and touches Manu’s head. He closes his eyes and nods at Lana.

LANA’S PRAYER IS IN LATIN.

LANA
Our Lord in Hell, hallowed be your name. Your Kingdom comes, your Will be done, on earth as in hell.

CROWD
Ave Satanas.

LANA
Us sinners invoke your name, now, at the hour of our death, and when we come back.

CROWD
Ave Satanas.

Smoke fumes out of the “X” in Manu’s back. He closes his eyes tightly.

LANA
Whosoever will be saved, before all things he must hold the unquestionable devotion to you.

CROWD
Ave Satanas.

Rui opens his eyes. They are white.

LANA
And the devotion is this: That we worship always and forever the Lord of the dead.

CROWD
Ave Satanas.

Rui levitates a little, his hand still glued to Manu’s head.

LANA
Who suffered for our salvation, descended into hell, and rose our brothers and sisters from the dead.

CROWD
Ave Satanas.

The “X” burns more and more. Manu gives up on the pain and lets go of agonizing screams.

LANA
He conquered hell, He sits on the throne made of bones of the ones who dare to challenge him.

CROWD
Ave Satanas.

LANA
From thence He shall come to judge the quick and the dead. At whose coming all men shall rise again with their bodies. And shall give an account of their own works.

CROWD
Ave Satanas.

Rui’s eyes turn pitch black. Manu’s screams get louder.

MANU
Please, STOP!

LANA
And the ones that have given their soles shall go into life everlasting. And those who haven’t must present a sacrifice

CROWD
Ave Satanas.

Rui CONVULSES aggressively. He takes his hand out of Manu’s head.

LANA
For the kingdom, the power, and the glory are yours. Now and forever.

Beat.

LANA (CONT’D)
Ave Satanas.

CROWD
Ave Satanas.

Manu SCREAMS in agony. His body twitches. His eyes filled with tears.

The crowd let go of each other's hands. They start humming again, this time louder.

Rui's eyes go back to normal as his feet slowly touch the ground.

CUT TO:

OVER BLACK

Sniff sounds.

CUT TO:

INT. EMA'S LIVING ROOM - NIGHT - PAST

Ema carefully makes short lines of coke using a razor blade. Manu dances to the sound of "*Parodia Familiar*".

Ema sniffs a line and looks up, laughing.

EMA
You got some good shit here.

MANU
New guy.

Manu dances toward the window where Praia lights reflect on him. He closes his eyes and places his head on the glass. It's loud outside, but the noise only echoes in his head.

MANU (CONT'D)
Imagine how the world would be if everyone was high all the time.

He laughs at the thought. He looks back, waiting for Ema to respond.

MANU (CONT'D)
Hey, don't have it all to yourself!

Manu stumbles across the room to Ema. She lies on the floor, murmuring. His eyes widen when he sees her face.

Ema bleeds through her nose and her eyes are semi-closed. Foam comes out of her mouth.

MANU (CONT'D)
E-Ema--

Manu kneels by her side and lifts her. He desperately looks around.

MANU (CONT'D)
Honey, look at me! It's gonna be ok... Where's my phone--

He gently places her head on the floor. Manu tries to stand up but gravity pulls him down. He stands up again, trembling, and desperately looks around the room.

MANU (CONT'D)
It's gonna be ok, Ema, I promise. Just do-don't close your eyes. Or fall asleep! They s-say it's worse if you do--

Tears roll down his eyes. His search for the phone gets more aggressive. Pillows and furniture fly across the living room, but he finds nothing.

MANU (CONT'D)
Ema, where's my phone? Ema?

Ema murmurs something. Manu stops and SLAPS himself a couple of times.

He walks over to Ema again and hugs her.

MANU (CONT'D)
I'm sorry. I'm so sorry Ema. I--
HELP! HELP! Someone help me, please!

Her eyes slowly close.

INT. MANU'S ROOM CABIN - DAY - PRESENT

Manu opens his eyes with difficulty. He groans in pain as he sits.

He walks over to the mirror, still wearing the purple robe from the night before. He takes it off and turns to see the reflection.

Manu frowns at the sight of the "X". It looks now like an old burning scar.

CRACK!

Manu TURNS around, overwhelmed. The sound of glass shatter comes from outside the room.

INT. MANU'S CABIN - CONTINUOUS

Manu's HEARTBEAT can be heard as he walks toward the noise. He freezes.

A silhouette of a woman cleans pieces of glass on the floor.

The woman stops and stands up. She slowly turns to Manu.

His eyes fill with tears.

It's Ema.

FADE TO BLACK.

END OF ACT FOUR

END OF PILOT